

Cluster 6: Agriculture, Sports, Energy and Renewables

This cluster contains the heavy July 31 cabinet decisions: PM-KISAN, revamped Khelo India, Samudra Manthan and PM-SSY. It is one of the highest-value revision clusters in the pack.

Current Affair: PM-KISAN Continuation

Date: 2026-07-31 | **Theme:** Agrarian welfare | **Subject:** Agriculture / Social welfare | **GS Mapping:** GS2 / GS3 | **Priority:** High | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:

PIB release: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2292437>(=1@=48

Fact snapshot

- PM-KISAN continued through 2030-31.
- The outlay is ■3.15 lakh crore.
- It remains a direct income support scheme with DBT delivery.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Outlay	■3.15 lakh crore approved for 2026-27 to 2030-31.	PIB	■	Prelims
Benefit	Eligible farmer families receive ■6,000 a year in three instalments.	PIB	■	Prelims
Scale	More than ■4.47 lakh crore transferred across 23 instalments.	PIB	■	Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Cabinet continuation approved on 31 July 2026.	PIB	■
Historical origin	Scheme launched in February 2019.	PIB	■
UPSC relevance	Farmer income support, DBT and welfare delivery.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
2019	PM-KISAN launched	Origin of the scheme	PIB	■
2026	Continuation approved to 2030-31	Current event	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Agriculture	Income support and farm investment	GS3	Syllabus	■
Governance	DBT and beneficiary authentication	GS2 / GS3	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
PM-KISAN	Income support scheme	Core scheme	PIB	■	Both
DBT	Direct benefit transfer	Delivery mechanism	PIB	■	Both

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
DBT	Direct Benefit Transfer	Cash transfer to bank accounts	Governance	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Eligibility	Assuming all farmers automatically qualify	It is for eligible landholding farmer families.	PIB	Prelims
Purpose	Confusing income support with loan waiver	PM-KISAN is a transfer-based support scheme.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Agrarian distress	Income support as a tool to stabilise rural households	GS3	Rural investment and resilience	PIB
Welfare delivery	DBT as a transparency mechanism	GS2 / GS3	Digital governance	PIB

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Agriculture, rural development, DBT	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB PM-KISAN release	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Political Philosophy	Distributive justice	The state compensates structural vulnerability by redistributing support	Use PM-KISAN as an example of welfare justice	GS2 / GS4 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Distributive justice concerns fair distribution when market outcomes are unequal.
- PM-KISAN is a clear policy example of the state supporting farmers directly.
- Use it to discuss welfare, fairness and the moral logic of transfers.
- Possible answer line: 'Direct income support can be seen as a corrective measure when livelihoods are structurally vulnerable.'
- Caution: do not present it as a substitute for all agricultural reform.

Inference

- The headline number to retain is ■3.15 lakh crore.
- The scheme's value is as much about welfare architecture as farm relief.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: PM-KISAN is a recurring example for DBT, welfare and agriculture.
- Static linkage: farm income, DBT, beneficiary targeting.
- Philosophy linkage: distributive justice and welfare support.

Revision Notes

- PM-KISAN continued through 2030-31.
- The outlay is ■3.15 lakh crore.
- It remains a direct income support scheme with DBT delivery.

Current Affair: Revamped Khelo India Scheme

Date: 2026-07-31 | **Theme:** Sports development | **Subject:** Sports / Youth | **GS Mapping:** GS2 / GS1 | **Priority:** Medium | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:
PIB release: [https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2292439\(=1@=48](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2292439(=1@=48)

Fact snapshot

- Outlay: ■36,441 crore.
- The scheme creates a full pathway from school sports to Olympic preparation.
- Feeder schools and high-performance structures are key recall points.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Outlay	Combined outlay of ■36,441 crore for 2026-27 to 2030-31.	PIB	■	Prelims
Goal	Create a pipeline from schools and villages to elite sport.	PIB	■	Mains
Institutions	NCOEs, KICs, academies and new feeder schools were added.	PIB	■	Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Cabinet approved a revamped scheme on 31 July 2026.	PIB	■
Historical origin	Khelo India had already become the flagship sports development programme.	Policy background	■
UPSC relevance	Sports policy, youth development and inclusion.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
Earlier phase	Khelo India became the central sports mission	Policy base	PIB	■
31 Jul 2026	Expanded scheme approved	Current event	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Sports policy	Grassroots-to-elite pathway	GS2	Syllabus	■
Youth	Fitness, inclusion and talent identification	GS1 / GS2	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Khelo India	Flagship sports scheme	Core policy item	PIB	■	Mains
Fit India	Fitness movement	Complementary initiative	PIB	■	Mains

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
NCOE	National Centre of Excellence	High-performance training node	Sports	PIB	■
KIC	Khelo India Centre	Grassroots sports hub	Sports	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Budget	Confusing old and new outlays	Use the revised outlay of ■36,441 crore.	PIB	Prelims
Purpose	Thinking it is only elite sports funding	It includes grassroots, school and inclusion layers.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Youth policy	Sports as an avenue of discipline and opportunity	GS1 / GS2	Inclusive sports ecosystem	PIB
Governance	How public investment can build sporting infrastructure	GS2 / GS3	Institutional design	PIB

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Sports governance, youth and fitness	Medium	Syllabus	Medium
Official source link	PIB Khelo India release	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Virtue Ethics	Excellence and fair opportunity	A sporting system cultivates discipline and equal opportunity for excellence	Use as a policy example of virtue formation through institutions	GS1 / GS2 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Virtue ethics values character traits like courage, discipline and excellence.
- Sports policy matters because it creates conditions where those virtues can be developed fairly.
- Use Khelo India as an example of institutional support for excellence.
- Possible answer line: 'Equal opportunity in sport is one way a society cultivates excellence without privilege.'
- Caution: keep the link to public policy, not a moral sermon.

Inference

- The scheme is a major sports-policy update and worth remembering with its outlay.
- Feeder schools and athlete pathway language are especially useful for mains answers.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: sports policy now links to education, health and social inclusion.
- Static linkage: sports infrastructure, talent identification, coaching, Fit India.
- Philosophy linkage: virtue ethics and equal opportunity.

Revision Notes

- Outlay: ■36,441 crore.
- The scheme creates a full pathway from school sports to Olympic preparation.
- Feeder schools and high-performance structures are key recall points.

Current Affair: Samudra Manthan - National Offshore Exploration Scheme

Date: 2026-07-31 | **Theme:** Energy security and hydrocarbons | **Subject:** Economy / Energy / Environment | **GS Mapping:** GS3 / GS2 | **Priority:** High | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:

PIB release: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2292445>

Fact snapshot

- Samudra Manthan is the offshore exploration scheme.
- The outlay is ₹84,084 crore.
- It is a central sector scheme of the Petroleum and Natural Gas Ministry.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Outlay	Approved outlay of ₹84,084 crore up to FY 2030-31.	PIB	■	Prelims
Purpose	Accelerate offshore hydrocarbon exploration.	PIB	■	Mains
Type	Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas.	PIB	■	Prelims

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Cabinet approved the scheme on 31 July 2026.	PIB	■
Historical origin	India has long pursued energy security and exploration reform.	Energy policy	■
UPSC relevance	Energy security, import dependence and domestic exploration.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
31 Jul 2026	Scheme approved	Current trigger	PIB	■
2030-31	Implementation horizon	Exam horizon	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Energy	Hydrocarbon exploration and energy security	GS3	Syllabus	■
Environment	Trade-off between energy security and sustainability	GS3 / GS2	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Samudra Manthan	Offshore exploration scheme	Core scheme	PIB	■	Mains
Petroleum & Natural Gas Ministry	Nodal ministry	Institutional owner	PIB	■	Prelims

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
FY	Financial Year	Implementation period	Energy policy	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Nature	Assuming it is a social welfare scheme	It is an offshore exploration scheme.	PIB	Prelims
Purpose	Thinking it is only about imports	It is mainly about domestic exploration and energy security.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Energy security	Why offshore exploration matters for import dependence	GS3	Hydrocarbon strategy	PIB
Sustainability	Energy transition does not eliminate the need for energy security	GS3	Balanced perspective	Synthesis

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Energy security, hydrocarbons, exploration	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB Samudra Manthan release	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Applied Philosophy / Ethics	Intergenerational justice	Current energy choices affect future generations	Use to discuss responsible resource use and future obligations	GS3 / Essay / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Intergenerational justice asks us to think beyond the present generation.
- Energy policy is a classic area where today's decisions affect tomorrow's options and risks.
- Use Samudra Manthan to discuss how states balance present energy needs and future sustainability.
- Possible answer line: 'Resource extraction is justified only when the present does not mortgage the future.'
- Caution: keep the linkage balanced; this scheme is about security, not just extraction.

Inference

- The name is memorable; the outlay and ministry are the exam facts.
- The current affair is most useful for energy-security and exploration questions.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: hydrocarbons remain central to India's energy-security debate.
- Static linkage: exploration, import dependence, energy transition.

- Philosophy linkage: intergenerational justice.

Revision Notes

- Samudra Manthan is the offshore exploration scheme.
- The outlay is ■84,084 crore.
- It is a central sector scheme of the Petroleum and Natural Gas Ministry.

Current Affair: Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana

Date: 2026-07-31 | **Theme:** Renewable energy and storage | **Subject:** Energy / Environment | **GS Mapping:** GS3 / GS2 | **Priority:** High | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:

PIB release: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2293256>(=1@=3

Fact snapshot

- PM-SSY supports 5,000 MW of floating solar PV.
- The scheme is linked to energy storage systems.
- It is meant to reduce land pressure and improve grid reliability.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Capacity	Supports 5,000 MW of floating solar PV projects.	PIB	■	Prelims
Storage	Co-located ESS with minimum two-hour storage (10,000 MWh).	PIB	■	Prelims
Outlay	■5,070 crore for FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31.	PIB	■	Prelims

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Scheme approved on 31 July 2026 and explained in PIB solar backgrounder.	PIB	■
Historical origin	Builds on India's broader solar and storage policy push.	Energy policy	■
UPSC relevance	Renewables, storage, land constraints and grid reliability.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
31 Jul 2026	PM-SSY approved	Current event	PIB	■
2030-31	Implementation window	Policy horizon	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Energy	Floating solar, storage and grid stability	GS3	Syllabus	■
Environment	Land-saving renewable deployment	GS3 / GS2	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
PM-SSY	Floating solar scheme	Core current affair	PIB	■	Mains
NISE assessment	Technical basis	Potential estimate of 102.18 GWp	PIB	■	Mains

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
FSPV	Floating Solar Photovoltaic	Solar plants on water bodies	Energy	PIB	■
ESS	Energy Storage System	Helps manage peak demand	Energy	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Storage	Thinking storage is optional	The scheme is explicitly paired with ESS.	PIB	Prelims
Land use	Assuming all solar must use land	This scheme uses reservoirs and ponds.	PIB	Prelims

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Energy transition	Floating solar as a land-efficient renewable solution	GS3	Grid reliability and storage	PIB
Federal policy	States and UTs can benefit from the scheme	GS2 / GS3	Centre-state implementation	PIB

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Renewables, energy storage, climate policy	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB PM-SSY release	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Environmental Ethics	Sustainability and intergenerational fairness	Using water bodies for solar can reduce land pressure while serving future needs	Use as a clean example of balancing development and conservation	GS3 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Environmental ethics asks how development can respect ecological limits.
- Floating solar is attractive because it saves land and supports energy transition.
- Use this topic to discuss sustainable development and responsibility to future generations.
- Possible answer line: 'Good environmental policy seeks efficiency, restraint and long-term balance.'
- Caution: do not ignore the engineering side; keep both ecology and infrastructure in view.

Inference

- The storage pairing is the key value addition; it is not just a solar scheme.
- Land-saving and grid-reliability are the two most useful phrases to recall.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: solar policy now blends climate, land use and storage.
- Static linkage: renewables, ESS, grid balancing, land constraints.
- Philosophy linkage: environmental ethics and sustainability.

Revision Notes

- PM-SSY supports 5,000 MW of floating solar PV.
- The scheme is linked to energy storage systems.
- It is meant to reduce land pressure and improve grid reliability.

Current Affair: Naxal-Free India

Date: 2026-08-01 | **Theme:** Internal security | **Subject:** Security / Governance | **GS Mapping:** GS3 / GS2 | **Priority:** High | **Suggested Depth:** Deep

Sources:

PIB press note: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressNoteDetails.aspx?ModuleId=3&NotelId;=159388&id;=159388>

Fact snapshot

- No district remained LWE-affected per the PIB note.
- The milestone was tied to 31 March 2026.
- Integrated strategy is the exam phrase: security, infrastructure, welfare, rehabilitation.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Milestone	No district remained LWE-affected, according to PIB.	PIB	■	Prelims + Mains
Date anchor	The milestone was linked to 31 March 2026.	PIB	■	Prelims
Strategy	Security, infrastructure, rehabilitation and welfare were combined.	PIB	■	Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	PIB backgrounder on 1 August 2026.	PIB	■
Historical origin	Naxalbari and Maoist insurgency created the LWE challenge.	PIB	■
UPSC relevance	Internal security, governance and development.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
1967	Naxalbari uprising	Origin of the movement	PIB	■
31 Mar 2026	Effectively free from LWE	Current milestone	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Internal security	Left Wing Extremism and insurgency	GS3	Syllabus	■
Governance	Whole-of-government approach and rehabilitation	GS2 / GS3	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
National Policy and Action Plan to address LWE	Policy framework	2015 pivot point	PIB	■	Mains
Surrender and rehabilitation policy	Reintegration mechanism	Incentives and dignity	PIB	■	Mains

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
LWE	Left Wing Extremism	Indian term for Naxal/Maoist insurgency	Security	PIB	■
CAPF	Central Armed Police Forces	Security deployment	Security	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Status	Assuming the issue vanished overnight	The release says effectively free and cites a long integrated strategy.	PIB	Mains
Solution	Thinking only force solved it	Development, welfare and rehabilitation are also central.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Security-development nexus	How roads, welfare and governance reinforce security	GS3	Integrated strategy	PIB
State legitimacy	Why welfare and trust matter in conflict zones	GS2 / GS3	Social contract angle	Synthesis

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	LWE, insurgency, governance, rehabilitation	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB Naxal-Free India backgrounder	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Political Philosophy	Social contract and legitimacy	The state must provide security, services and recognition to sustain legitimacy	Use as a case of restoring trust in the state	GS2 / GS3 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Social contract thinking says people accept state authority when the state protects and serves them.
- In conflict zones, legitimacy grows when security is matched by welfare and inclusion.
- Use the Naxal-free story to show how trust and governance are philosophical as well as administrative issues.
- Possible answer line: 'The durable defeat of insurgency requires not only force but the restoration of political legitimacy.'
- Caution: keep the analysis grounded in the official strategy described in the release.

Inference

- This is an important internal security success story.
- The structural strategy matters more than the headline declaration alone.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: internal security answers often need the security-development-rehabilitation triangle.
- Static linkage: LWE history, CAPF, rehabilitation, governance in remote areas.
- Philosophy linkage: legitimacy, trust and the social contract.

Revision Notes

- No district remained LWE-affected per the PIB note.
- The milestone was tied to 31 March 2026.
- Integrated strategy is the exam phrase: security, infrastructure, welfare, rehabilitation.

Cluster Self-Test

- Which scheme was extended with ₹3.15 lakh crore outlay?

- PM-KISAN
- PM-SSY
- PM-VBRY
- NVHCP

Answer: PM-KISAN

Why: That outlay belongs to PM-KISAN.

- Which scheme got ₹36,441 crore?

- Khelo India
- PM-SSY
- Samudra Manthan
- Digital India

Answer: Khelo India

Why: That is the sports outlay.

- Samudra Manthan is associated with:

- Offshore exploration
- School labs
- Fungal disease control
- GI branding

Answer: Offshore exploration

Why: It is the National Offshore Exploration Scheme.

- PM-SSY directly supports which energy form?

- Floating solar with storage
- Coal gasification
- Nuclear waste
- Diesel subsidy

Answer: Floating solar with storage

Why: The scheme is for FSPV plus ESS.

- Which philosophy theme best fits the energy pair in this cluster?

- Environmental ethics
- Pessimism
- Determinism only
- None

Answer: Environmental ethics

Why: Solar and offshore energy raise sustainability questions.

Topic Readiness / Worthiness

Topic	Worthiness Score	One-line reason
PM-KISAN	9.5/10	Core agrarian welfare scheme.
Khelo India	8.9/10	Strong sports-policy update.
Samudra Manthan	9.0/10	Energy security and exploration anchor.
PM-SSY	9.1/10	Excellent renewables and storage topic.